

n8n Interview Questions & Answers

1. What is n8n?

n8n (pronounced "n-eight-n") is an open-source workflow automation tool that lets you connect APIs, services, and databases without writing code, using a visual node-based editor.

2. How does n8n differ from Zapier or Integromat?

Unlike Zapier/Integromat, n8n is self-hostable, fully open-source, and allows custom JavaScript code in nodes. It also offers unlimited workflows without per-task pricing.

3. What are the main components of an n8n workflow?

- ***Trigger nodes***: start the workflow (e.g., webhook, schedule).
- ***Action/Function nodes***: perform operations (HTTP request, database query, code).
- ***Control flow nodes***: IF, Switch, SplitInBatches, etc.
- ***Credentials***: securely store API keys for reuse.

4. Explain how credentials are managed in n8n.

Credentials are stored encrypted in the database (or .env) and referenced by nodes. They can be shared across workflows, and you can define custom credential types.

5. What is a webhook node and how is it used?

A webhook node creates an HTTP endpoint that external services can call to trigger the workflow. It can be set to listen for GET, POST, etc., and can pass the request payload to subsequent nodes.

6. How can you handle errors in n8n workflows?

Use the ***Error Trigger*** node to catch errors, or configure the ***Execute Workflow*** node with "Continue On Fail". Additionally, the ***IF*** node can evaluate error conditions.

7. Describe the purpose of the "Execute Workflow" node.

It allows one workflow to call another, passing data via input parameters and receiving output, enabling modular workflow design.

8. What is the "SplitInBatches" node used for?

It splits an array of items into smaller batches, useful for rate-limited APIs or processing large data sets in chunks.

9. How do you store data temporarily within a workflow?

Use the ***Set*** node to create variables, or the ***Function*** node to assign values to `items[0].json``. The ***Store*** node can persist data across executions if needed.

10. Can you write custom JavaScript in n8n? If so, where?

Yes. Use the ***Function*** or ***Function Item*** nodes to run custom JavaScript on the workflow data.

11. What databases are supported out-of-the-box?

n8n includes native nodes for MySQL, PostgreSQL, SQLite, MongoDB, and Microsoft SQL Server.

12. How would you schedule a recurring task?

Use the ***Cron*** node (or ***Schedule Trigger***) to define intervals, specific times, or complex cron expressions.

13. Explain the concept of "nodes" and "items" in n8n.

A node is a step in the workflow. Each node processes an array of ***items*** (objects). Nodes can add, remove, or

transform items, and the array flows to the next node.

14. What is the purpose of the "Merge" node?

It combines data from multiple branches (e.g., *Append*, *Combine*, *Wait*, *Pass-Through*) allowing parallel workflows to converge.

15. How can you secure a self-hosted n8n instance?

- Enable HTTPS (TLS).
- Use environment variables for credentials.
- Set up authentication (basic auth, JWT, OAuth).
- Restrict access via firewall or VPN.

16. Describe how to deploy n8n using Docker.

Run the official Docker image, mount a persistent volume for the database, and set required env vars (e.g., `N8N\_HOST`, `N8N\_BASIC\_AUTH\_USER`, `N8N\_BASIC\_AUTH\_PASSWORD`).

17. What is the "Execute Command" node?

It runs shell commands on the host machine, allowing interaction with the OS, file system, or other CLI tools.

18. How do you pass data between workflows?

Use the *Execute Workflow* node's "Input Data" field and configure the called workflow to accept parameters via the *Workflow Trigger* node.

19. Can n8n integrate with cloud services like AWS or GCP?

Yes. There are dedicated nodes for S3, SQS, DynamoDB, Google Sheets, Google Drive, and you can also use generic HTTP request nodes with appropriate credentials.

20. What are best practices for designing scalable n8n workflows?

- Keep nodes atomic and reusable.
- Use the *Execute Workflow* node for modularity.
- Limit batch sizes to respect API rate limits.
- Monitor performance with the built-in execution logs.
- Store secrets securely and avoid hard-coding values.

Prepared for interview preparation.